

Long + Strong

Improve VO2 max. Rebuild the long run. Drop weight gradually. Restore dependable strength.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Easy run + strides	VO2 quality	Strength A squat + bench	Easy run	Strength B deadlift + full body	Rest walk or mobility	Long easy run

The run build

WEEK	MONDAY	TUESDAY QUALITY	THURSDAY	SUNDAY LONG	TOTAL
1	5 km easy + 4 strides	6 x 2 min / 2 min jog 7 km	4 km easy	8 km easy	24 km
2	6 km easy + 6 strides	5 x 3 min / 2 min jog 7 km	5 km easy	10 km easy	28 km
3	6 km easy + 6 strides	4 x 4 min / 3 min jog 8 km	5 km easy	12 km easy	31 km
4	5 km easy + 4 strides	8 x 1 min / 1 min jog 6 km	4 km easy	9 km easy	24 km
5	6 km easy + 6 strides	5 x 4 min / 2:30 jog 8 km	5 km easy	13 km easy	32 km
6	7 km easy + 6 strides	6 x 3 min uphill 9 km	5 km easy	14 km easy	35 km
7	7 km easy + 8 strides	3 x 8 x 30 sec hard / 30 float 9 km	6 km easy	16 km easy	38 km
8	5 km easy + 4 strides	5 km controlled time trial 8 km	4 km easy	11 km easy	28 km

EASY	QUALITY	NON-NEGOTIABLE
Conversational, RPE 2 to 3. Strides are quick and relaxed.	RPE 8, hard and repeatable. Warm up 12 to 15 minutes. Never sprint.	No doubles. Saturday stays easy. Do not cram missed work into the next three days.

Keep the engine honest

Two full-body sessions. Low enough volume to recover, heavy enough to retain muscle and rebuild the lifts.

WEDNESDAY, STRENGTH A	WORK	FRIDAY, STRENGTH B	WORK
Back squat	3 x 4 to 6, 2 RIR	Conventional or trap-bar deadlift	2 x 3 to 5, 2 RIR
Bench press	3 x 4 to 6, 2 RIR	Front-foot-elevated split squat	2 x 6 to 8 each
Romanian deadlift	2 x 6 to 8, 2 RIR	Incline press	3 x 6 to 10
Chest-supported row	3 x 8 to 10	Pulldown or weighted chin-up	3 x 6 to 10
Standing calf raise	3 x 8 to 12	Seated soleus raise	3 x 10 to 15
Ab wheel or cable crunch	2 x 8 to 12	Lateral raise	3 x 12 to 20
		Heavy farmer carry	3 x 30 to 40 m

Progression

Week 1 sets honest working loads. Add 2.5 kg upper or 5 kg lower only when every rep is clean with two left. Week 4 removes one set everywhere. Week 8 removes one squat and deadlift set. No 1RM test.

Weight loss without flattening training

1	Seven morning weigh-ins. Judge the weekly average only.
2	Lose 0.25 to 0.5% of body weight each week. Start with a 300 to 400 kcal daily average deficit.
3	Protein: 1.8 to 2.0 g per kg per day, spread across three to five meals.
4	Take 30 to 60 g carbohydrate before Tuesday and Sunday. Use 30 to 60 g per hour beyond 75 minutes.

Knee and readiness rails

GREEN	AMBER	RED
Normal gait. Knee 0 to 1/10. No swelling. Run the plan.	Pain builds, changes mechanics or stays up next morning. Remove the next quality session.	Swelling, locking, giving way, sharp focal pain or altered gait. Stop and get assessed.

Eight-week win

Six solid weeks out of eight. Long run at 16 km with a quiet knee. Body-weight average down 2 to 4% if recovery supports it. Working weights trending up with two reps still in reserve.